

CAPM EXAM AT A GLANCE

Items	150 total — 135 scored, 15 unscored pretest
Time	3 hours
Break	One 10-minute break after question 75; you cannot return to earlier questions
Formats	Multiple choice, drag-and-drop, hot spot, animation/comic-strip scenarios
Blueprint	2023 CAPM Exam Content Outline

DOMAIN WEIGHTS (2023 ECO)

Domain	Share of items
1. Project Management Fundamentals and Core Concepts	36%
2. Predictive, Plan-Based Methodologies	17%
3. Agile Frameworks / Methodologies	20%
4. Business Analysis Frameworks	27%

TIP Business analysis is 27% — bigger than predictive. Requirements elicitation, traceability and validation are worth as much study time as the schedule mechanics.

FORMULAS THAT SHOW UP

Cost variance	$CV = EV - AC$ Negative = over budget
Schedule variance	$SV = EV - PV$ Negative = behind plan
Cost index	$CPI = EV \div AC$ Under 1.0 = over budget
Schedule index	$SPI = EV \div PV$ Under 1.0 = behind plan
Forecast cost	$EAC = BAC \div CPI$ If current performance continues
Three-point (beta)	$(O + 4M + P) \div 6$ Triangular is $(O + M + P) \div 3$
Total float	$LS - ES$ Critical-path activities normally have zero total float; constraints can create positive or negative float
Communication channels	$n(n - 1) \div 2$ $n = \text{people}$
Expected monetary value	$EMV = \text{probability} \times \text{impact}$

FUNDAMENTALS AND CORE CONCEPTS

- Project = temporary, creates a unique result. Operations are ongoing.
- Program = related projects managed together; portfolio = work aligned to strategy.
- Project charter authorises the project and names the project manager.
- Deliverable-based WBS; the lowest level is the work package.
- Baselines are scope, schedule and cost — changed only through change control.
- Functional, matrix, projectised: authority rises left to right.

KNOW WHICH DOCUMENT DOES WHAT

Document	Purpose
Business case	Justifies the investment
Project charter	Authorises the project, names the PM
Scope statement	What is and is not included
WBS dictionary	Detail behind each work package
Risk register	Risks, owners, planned responses
Issue log	Current issues needing action, including risks that occurred
Stakeholder register	Who they are, interest, influence
Lessons learned register	Updated throughout, not only at the end

CHOOSING AN APPROACH

- Stable requirements, heavy compliance, fixed scope: predictive.
- Volatile requirements, fast feedback, unclear solution: adaptive.
- Some of each, or staged delivery against a fixed date: hybrid.
- Tailor to the project — no single life cycle is the right answer by default.
- Governance, compliance and organisational policy override personal preference.



PREDICTIVE, PLAN-BASED

- Flow: authorise with the charter; plan and baseline; execute while monitoring and controlling; then close.
- Critical path = the longest path through the network; it sets the shortest possible duration and normally has zero total float, though constraints can change that.
- Crashing adds cost by adding resources; fast tracking adds risk by overlapping work.
- Dependencies: mandatory, discretionary, external, internal.
- Quality is planned in and verified by control quality; validate scope gets customer acceptance.
- Close the project only after deliverables are accepted and records are archived.

AGILE FRAMEWORKS

Framework	Remember
Scrum	Three accountabilities, events and artefacts; sprint is one month or less
Kanban	Visualise flow, limit work in progress, pull work
XP	Pairing, TDD, refactoring, continuous integration
Lean	Remove waste, optimise the whole
Scrum of Scrums	Coordinates several teams on one product

AGILE RECALL

- The manifesto values the left side more; it does not discard the right side.
- Product owner orders the backlog; the team pulls what it can finish.
- Sprint events: planning, daily scrum (15 min), review, retrospective.
- Definition of done applies to every increment; acceptance criteria are per story.
- Velocity forecasts one team's future sprints — it is not a performance score.
- Information radiators make status visible without a status meeting.

BUSINESS ANALYSIS (27%)

- Needs assessment and the business case come before requirements.
- Elicitation: interviews, workshops, observation, surveys, document analysis, prototyping.
- Requirement types: business, stakeholder, solution (functional and non-functional, including quality), and transition.
- A traceability matrix links requirements to their origin or business objective and forward to deliverables, verification and validation.
- Verification asks "built right"; validation asks "built the right thing".
- Backlog refinement is how agile teams manage requirements over time.
- Solution evaluation checks whether the delivered value matched the business case.

COMMON TRAPS

- A risk that occurs becomes an issue: manage it in the issue log and update or close the related risk-register entry as appropriate.
- Validate scope is customer acceptance; control quality is the internal check.
- Crashing costs money, fast tracking costs risk — do not swap them.
- The critical path is the longest path, never the shortest.
- Velocity and story points belong to one team; do not compare teams.

TEST-DAY PLAN

1. About 72 seconds per question — flag and move rather than stall.
2. Read the final sentence first, then find the facts that answer it.
3. Match the answer to the stated delivery approach and scenario, not to keywords in the wording.
4. Clear the flags before the break at question 75 — you cannot go back.
5. Never leave an item blank; there is no penalty for guessing.

TIP Confirm question counts, timing and break rules in the current PMI Certification Handbook and CAPM Exam Content Outline before your appointment.

